K S RANGASAMY COLLEGE OF TECHNOLOGY

Department of Information Technology

Presented By

Karuppannan S

2303737720521035

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AI Safety Mechanisms In ChatGPT

The Stakes: Why AI Safety Matters

Millions of Users

ChatGPT helps millions boost productivity and creativity daily, from students to professionals

Real Risks

AI also poses risks: misuse, harmful content generation, and privacy breaches that must be addressed

Our Mission

OpenAI is committed to building AI that is safe, aligned with human values, and broadly beneficial

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Safety Built In: The Multi-Step Approach

AI safety requires a comprehensive, layered strategy spanning the entire development lifecycle.

Pre-Training

Filtering harmful data from training sets and teaching foundational ethical principles

Post-Training

Reinforcement learning with human feedback (RLHF) to align model behavior with safety goals

Pre-Deployment

Rigorous safety evaluations and red teaming exercises to identify vulnerabilities

Post-Deployment

Real-time monitoring systems and continuous improvement based on user feedback

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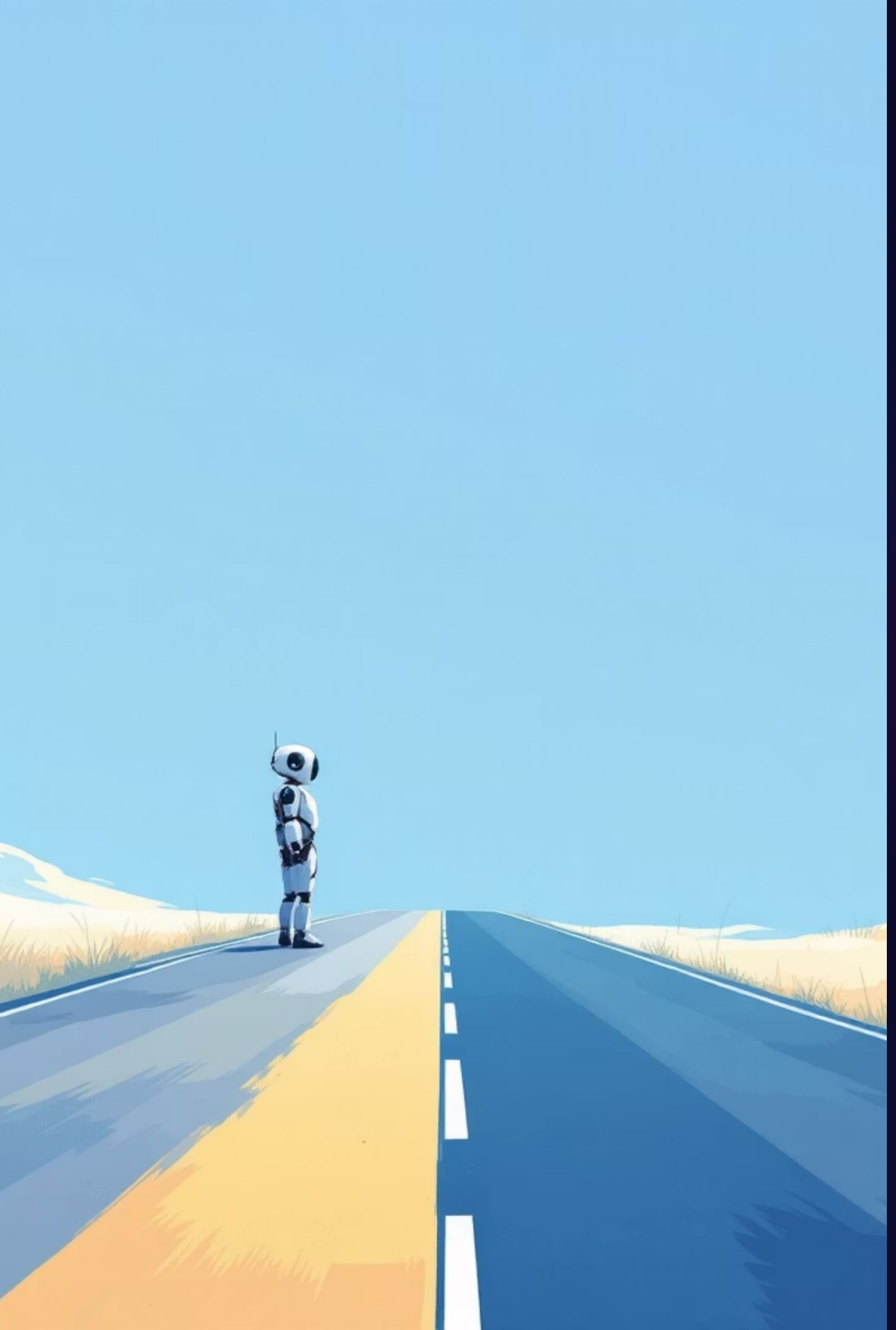

From Hard Refusals to Safe Completions: GPT-5's Breakthrough

Old Method

Binary refusal or compliance on risky prompts—limited flexibility

New Approach

Context-aware "safe completions" that maximize helpfulness within safety boundaries

Dual-Use Balance

Declines detailed pyrotechnics instructions but offers safe guidance when appropriate

Smarter Decisions

Understands context to distinguish harmful intent from legitimate curiosity

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Real-Time Safety Systems in Action

Multiple automated and human-powered systems work together to detect and prevent harmful content.

Automated Classifiers

Scans text, images, and audio in real-time for harmful content using advanced machine learning models

Human Review Teams

Expert reviewers and partner organizations like Internet Watch Foundation assist in complex detection cases

Risk Profiling

Safety identifiers track user risk profiles to prevent abuse and enforce community policies

Enforcement Actions

Responses range from delayed processing to account suspension for repeated violations

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Protecting Children and Teens: Age-Appropriate Experiences

Age Detection

AI detects user age to tailor content and reduce exposure to harmful material

Special Safeguards

Limits graphic content, viral challenges, and risky roleplay for users under 18

Parental Controls

Tools rolling out to empower families in managing AI interactions safely

Continuous input from child safety experts shapes evolving protections for young users.

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Conclusion: Building Trustworthy AI for Everyone

Continuous Journey

AI safety is an ongoing process, not a one-time fix—requiring constant vigilance and adaptation

Layered Protection

OpenAI's comprehensive safety mechanisms protect users while enabling responsible innovation

Shared Responsibility

Together, we can harness AI's power responsibly for a better future through collaboration

Let's stay informed, vigilant, and collaborative as AI continues to evolve and shape our world.

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